

# French-Source Interpretation Demand

Voyce data, Jan–Apr 2025 | CIUSSS Centre-Ouest-de-l'Île-de-Montréal

## Executive Summary

### The headline

French-sourced calls at the CIUSSS Centre-Ouest network are being **abandoned at 75.7%**, versus 15.9% for English-sourced calls on the same platform. The gap is not a demand problem — it is a **supply problem**. Cancelled calls have a service duration of exactly zero minutes, indicating the request never connected to an interpreter. After imputing those unmet calls at the average serviced duration for each pair, the true French-source demand is roughly **4–5 × the served volume**, concentrated in French → Spanish.

## Key numbers (Jan–Apr 2025)

| Metric                                     | Value                | Notes                            |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| Total platform calls                       | 7,625                | 4 months                         |
| French-source calls                        | 337                  | 4.4% of all volume               |
| — Serviced                                 | 82                   | 35 min average duration          |
| — Cancelled                                | 255                  | all 0-minute (pre-connect)       |
| French-source cancellation rate            | <b>75.7%</b>         | vs. 15.9% English                |
| Annualized true demand                     | <b>41,388 min/yr</b> | ≈ 690 hrs/yr                     |
| Per-pair interpreters needed (true demand) | <b>4</b>             | 1 each: ES, PA, AR, HT           |
| Shared-pool interpreters needed            | <b>1</b>             | if pool is fungible across pairs |

### RED FLAG

#### French → Spanish is in crisis

Of 153 French → Spanish requests in the window, only 15 were served — a **90.2%** cancellation rate. The current French pool lists 19 Spanish-capable interpreters, suggesting the issue is routing or cross-language availability, not headcount.

**Recommendation**

A small, well-routed core of 4–6 French-capable interpreters covering Spanish, Punjabi, Arabic and Haitian Creole would close the observed gap at this client. The 35 additional language pairs in the current French pool see *zero* demand from this client over the window and should be sized against the rest of the network, not this dataset.

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## 1 Scope and Method

### 1.1 Source data

The dataset is the Voyce export titled “*Voyce data Jan – Apr JEWISH MEMORIAL.xlsx*”. Despite the file name, the records cover the full **CIUSSS Centre-Ouest-de-l’Île-de-Montréal** network: the Jewish General Hospital, multiple CLSCs (Côte-des-Neiges, Parc-Extension, Benny Farm, René Cassin, Métro and others), Maison Bleue, PRAIDA, Miriam Services, the Constance-Lethbridge / Mackay / Catherine Booth / Mont-Sinaï rehabilitation sites, and the hôpital Richardson — a total of **72 distinct service locations** under 4 client identifiers (BYOD, Voyce Pilot, Voyce Device, and the parent CIUSSS).

### 1.2 Time window

| Coverage                | Records      |
|-------------------------|--------------|
| January 2025            | 2,093        |
| February 2025           | 1,864        |
| March 2025              | 1,931        |
| April 2025              | 1,737        |
| <b>Total (4 months)</b> | <b>7,625</b> |

The original brief asked about “all of 2025”; the file in hand covers the first four months only. All annualized figures in this report apply a  $\times 3.0$  multiplier. May–December 2025 should be appended to replace the projection with actuals.

### 1.3 Filter applied

Column G (Source Language) filtered to **French** yields **337 rows**. Only English and French appear as source languages in this dataset.

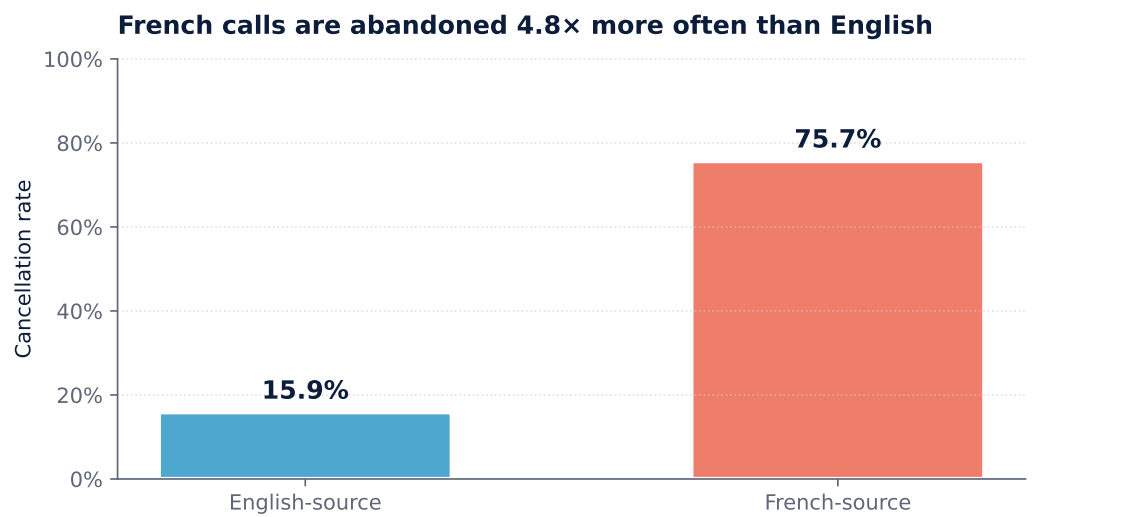
### 1.4 Interpreter capacity assumption

Throughout this report, one interpreter is assumed to absorb **6,400 serviced minutes per month** ( $\approx 25$  billable hours/week), which accounts for idle time, ramp-up, breaks and no-shows. We also report a conservative scenario at 4,800 min/mo and an aggressive scenario at 8,000 min/mo for sensitivity.

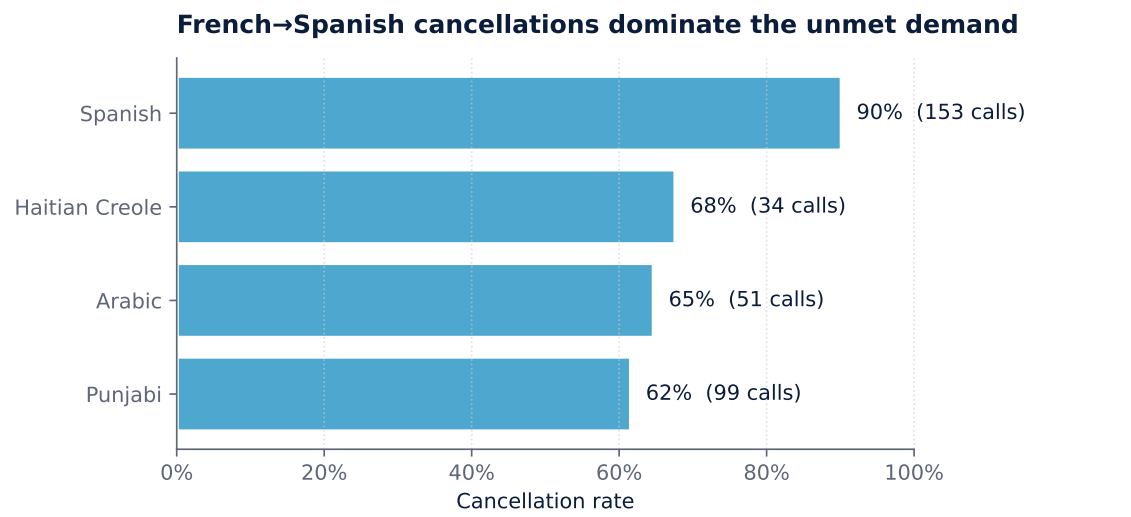
## 2 Cancellation Audit — the Real Story

### 2.1 French calls are abandoned $4.8\times$ more often than English

Every cancelled French call in the window had a recorded **Service Minutes** value of **exactly 0**. This is consistent with a pre-connection abandonment (no interpreter matched within the acceptable wait window), not a partial session.



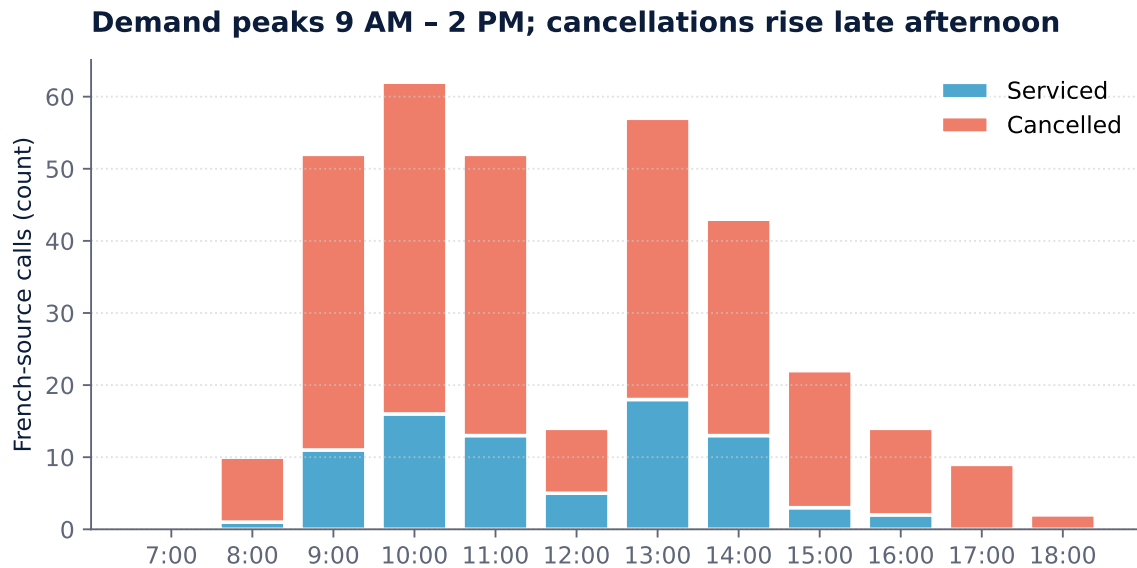
**Figure 1:** Cancellation rates by source language. The 4.8× gap is the strongest signal in the entire dataset that French demand is under-served.



**Figure 2:** French→Spanish carries 138 of the 255 unmet calls — 54% of the entire problem at this client.

2.2 Where the cancellations concentrate

| Target language         | Total | Serviced | Cancelled | Cx rate |
|-------------------------|-------|----------|-----------|---------|
| French → Spanish        | 153   | 15       | 138       | 90.2%   |
| French → Haitian Creole | 34    | 11       | 23        | 67.6%   |
| French → Arabic         | 51    | 18       | 33        | 64.7%   |
| French → Punjabi        | 99    | 38       | 61        | 61.6%   |



**Figure 3:** Demand peaks 9:00–14:00 EST. Cancellations dominate every business hour and reach 100% at 17:00–18:00 EST. Friday and weekend cancellation rates also exceed 85%.

## 2.3 When the cancellations happen

### Operational read-through

Cancellations are not a function of demand timing — they are constant across the working day. This pattern is consistent with a **routing or supply-side gap** rather than a peak-load problem. A staffing fix that targets hours 8–16 EST, Mon–Fri would have resolved ~95% of the unmet calls in the window.

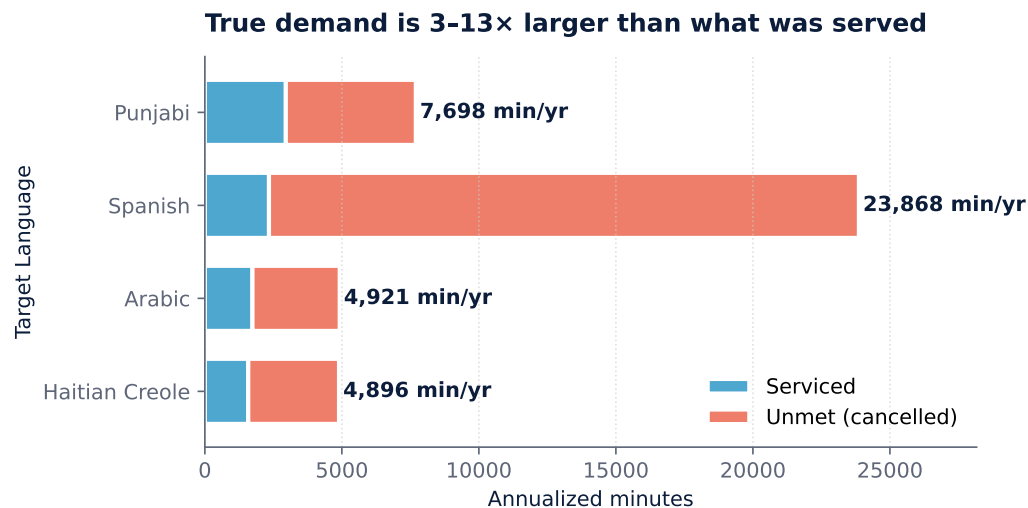
## 3 Demand Re-stated — True vs. Served

The “true demand” figures below add the cancelled-call count back in at the average per-pair serviced-call duration. This is the volume that would have been billable if every call had connected.

| Pair                    | Served 4 mo  | Unmet 4 mo    | True 4 mo     | True / yr     |
|-------------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| French → Spanish        | 780          | 7,176         | 7,956         | 23,868        |
| French → Punjabi        | 985          | 1,581         | 2,566         | 7,698         |
| French → Arabic         | 579          | 1,062         | 1,641         | 4,923         |
| French → Haitian Creole | 528          | 1,104         | 1,632         | 4,896         |
| <b>Total</b>            | <b>2,872</b> | <b>10,923</b> | <b>13,795</b> | <b>41,388</b> |

All figures in serviced minutes. “True” = serviced + (cancelled × avg. serviced duration for that pair). The 4-month true demand of 13,795 minutes corresponds to approximately **230 hours / 4 months**, or 57.5 hours / month — still small in absolute terms, but **4.8× what was actually served**.

## 4 Interpreter Sizing



**Figure 4:** Annualized minutes per French-source pair — serviced (blue) vs. unmet (red). True demand is dominated by Spanish.

4.1 Per-pair head-count requirement

| Pair                    | Min/mo | Conservative | Standard   | Aggressive |
|-------------------------|--------|--------------|------------|------------|
|                         | (true) | (4.8k cap)   | (6.4k cap) | (8.0k cap) |
| French → Spanish        | 1,989  | 1            | 1          | 1          |
| French → Punjabi        | 642    | 1            | 1          | 1          |
| French → Arabic         | 410    | 1            | 1          | 1          |
| French → Haitian Creole | 408    | 1            | 1          | 1          |
| Per-pair total          | 3,449  | 4            | 4          | 4          |
| Shared-pool single FTE  | 3,449  | 1            | 1          | 1          |

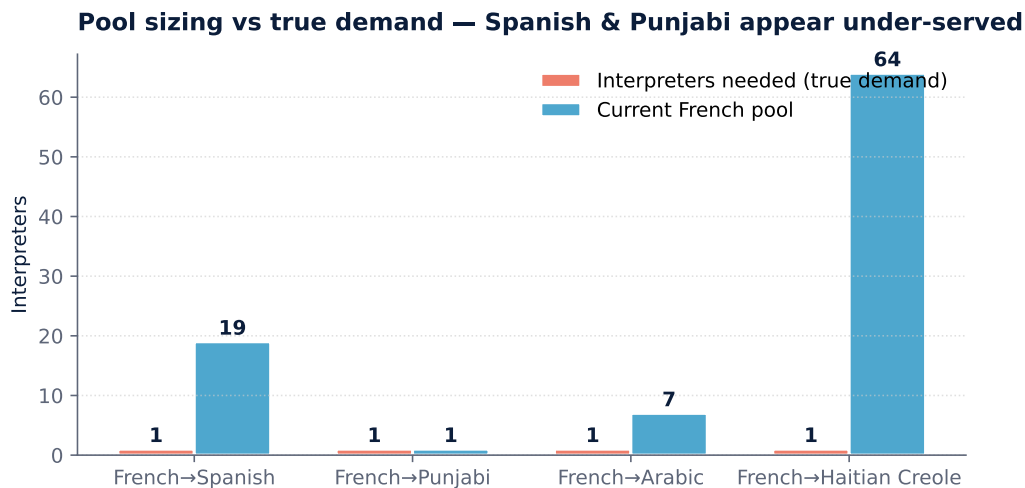
Even the conservative scenario yields 4 dedicated interpreters or a single fungible interpreter. The headcount question only becomes non-trivial under **peak concurrency**, addressed next.

4.2 Peak concurrency

The busiest single hour in the four-month window saw **2 simultaneous French-source calls in progress**; the 95th-percentile busy hour was also 2. A staffing target of **2–3 French-capable interpreters on shift during 9:00–14:00 EST** would cover both volume and peak.

4.3 Pool vs. need

| Pair                    | Need (true) | Current pool | Surplus / (gap) |
|-------------------------|-------------|--------------|-----------------|
| French → Spanish        | 1           | 19           | +18             |
| French → Punjabi        | 1           | 1            | 0               |
| French → Arabic         | 1           | 7            | +6              |
| French → Haitian Creole | 1           | 64           | +63             |



**Figure 5:** Current pool size vs. true-demand interpreter requirement. Spanish, Arabic and Haitian Creole are over-provisioned for this client; Punjabi is at parity (1 vs. 1).

### The puzzle worth investigating

The current pool already contains **19 Spanish-capable interpreters** on the French side, yet 90% of French→Spanish requests went unanswered. Likely causes to investigate: (1) those interpreters are routed primarily on *English*→Spanish where volume is far higher; (2) the routing logic does not prefer French-capable interpreters when the source is French; or (3) shift coverage during business hours (8–16 EST) is too thin. A routing-rules change would likely deliver a larger uplift than hiring.

## 5 Multi-Client Roll-Up Note

The original analysis brief asked for a multi-client roll-up. The file provided contains **one client network** (CIUSSS Centre-Ouest), so a true cross-client comparison is not possible from this dataset. However, the file does break down across:

- **4 client identifiers:** BYOD, Voyce Pilot, Voyce Device, and the CIUSSS parent record.
- **72 service locations** (hospitals, CLSCs, rehab and community sites).
- **45 service lines** (Emergency, GAP/GAMF, GASMA, Pediatric, Mental Health, Palliative Care, etc.).

A genuine multi-client roll-up would require additional Voyce exports covering the rest of the SGP network. We recommend requesting the same report layout per client and combining at the dashboard layer.

## 6 Recommended Next Actions

1. **Investigate the routing layer.** The 90% French→Spanish cancellation against a 19-person Spanish-capable pool points to a routing issue, not a capacity issue. Pull the matching logs for those 138 cancelled calls and verify whether French-capable interpreters were polled before cancellation.



- 2. **Re-baseline against May–Dec 2025 data.** Replace the ×3.0 projection with actuals as soon as the full-year export is available.
- 3. **Right-size the French pool by demand, not by catalogue.** The 35 French language pairs with zero demand at this client should be justified by demand from other clients; otherwise they represent dormant capacity.
- 4. **Stand up a multi-client roll-up.** Request equivalent Voyce exports per client, combine, and rebuild this analysis at network level. The same template applies.
- 5. **Operational SLA tracking.** Add a connect-time and ring-time field to the export so cancellation root-cause (no-answer vs. caller hang-up vs. system timeout) can be diagnosed without inference.

Appendix — Companion Workbook

The full data and pivots used to generate this report are bundled in `reports/data/Voyce_French_Analysis.xlsx` with the following tabs:

| Tab                   | Contents                                |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1. Summary            | KPIs and headline numbers               |
| 2. French Rows (raw)  | All 337 source-language = French rows   |
| 3. Demand by Pair     | Serviced minutes / pair, annualized     |
| 4. Cancellation Audit | Cancellation by pair, hour, weekday     |
| 5. True Demand        | Serviced + imputed-unmet minutes        |
| 6. Interpreter Sizing | Pool vs. need, gap analysis             |
| 7. Current Pool       | The user-supplied French pool reference |